

FOUNDERS DRIVE

Roast My Startup — Event & Ecosystem Plan

Concept: 5 minutes to pitch. 10 minutes to get challenged. 30–90 days to prove the feedback right or wrong.

Executive Summary

Founders Drive should position Roast My Startup as a founder reality-check and accountability programme—not a comedy roast. Four Malaysian startups are selected each month to pitch for five minutes, followed by ten minutes of structured challenge from rotating guests including VCs, industry seniors, experienced founders, mentors and ecosystem personalities.

The key differentiator is the follow-through: every startup receives a documented Reality Check, an Action Plan, access to relevant help, and a follow-up review showing what the founder implemented, what changed, and what results were achieved.

Founders Drive can then grow into a broader Malaysian startup ecosystem platform covering startup discovery, founder profiles, funding status, investor profiles, VC matching, perks, competitions, podcast/content and introductions.

1. Roast My Startup — Core Format

Segment	Duration	Purpose
Founder pitch	5 min	Problem, solution, market, traction, business model, team and ask
Reality Check	10 min	Challenge assumptions, business approach, GTM, product, fundraising and execution
Transition / verdict	~2–3 min	Summarise critical findings and immediate priorities

Monthly capacity: 4 startups per event, approximately 60–75 minutes of core programming, plus networking.

2. Reality Check Framework

Roasters should move beyond generic criticism and identify why the startup is moving slowly, where the business approach is weak, and what the founder needs to change or accelerate.

Business

Is the problem real? Will customers pay? Is pricing viable? Is the business model sustainable?

Product

Are the founders solving the right problem? Is the product too complex? Are customers actually using it?

Market

Is the target market realistic? Is the ICP too broad? Is the market ready?

Go-to-Market

Is acquisition repeatable? Are sales cycles too long? Is CAC sustainable? Who is the economic buyer?

Fundraising

Is the company genuinely fundable at its current stage? Is the funding ask supported by traction?

Execution

What is slowing the company down? What should the founders stop, start or accelerate?

3. From Criticism to Action

Every major point should follow a WHY → WHAT → HOW → WHO structure.

Example: Customer acquisition is too expensive → Why: target market is too broad and sales cycle is 9–12 months → What: narrow the ICP → How: run a 90-day pilot with 20 target customers → Who: introduce two operators, one potential customer and one relevant mentor.

4. Founders Drive Reality Check Report

- Overall Reality Check Score /100
- Critical issues
- Important issues
- Strengths
- Top three recommended actions
- People / customers / investors who can help
- Founder commitment and target dates

5. The 30-Day Action Plan

Each selected founder leaves with a concrete 30-day plan. Actions should be measurable and time-bound—for example: conduct 20 customer interviews, validate pricing with 10 customers, revise ICP, launch a pilot, recruit a sales lead, or prepare a new fundraising narrative.

6. Follow-Up & Accountability

The platform should track each issue raised during the event and allow the founder to mark it as Implemented, Partially Implemented, Testing or Rejected—with an explanation and evidence.

The signature content format should be **You Said / We Did**: what the panel challenged, what the founder changed, and what happened as a result.

7. 30 / 60 / 90-Day Founder Journey

Stage	Output
Event Day	Pitch + Reality Check + verdict
Day 7	Final Action Plan
Day 30	Progress update
Day 60	Results / experiments update
Day 90	Reality Check 2 + progress score + case study

8. Founder Help & Matching

At the end of the event, founders identify the specific help they need: customer introductions, fundraising advice, GTM mentoring, technical advice, hiring, partnerships, international expansion or investor introductions. Founders Drive then matches these needs to people in its ecosystem.

9. Startup Directory

The Founders Drive website should maintain a searchable directory of Malaysian startups with company profile, founders, sector, stage, funding history, investors, traction, website, fundraising status and a controlled 'Request Introduction' mechanism.

Avoid publishing founders' private contact details by default. Use controlled introductions so founders can accept or decline connections.

10. Investor / VC Directory

Investor profiles should include fund name, current fund status, stage preferences, geography, ticket size, sectors, lead/co-invest preference, portfolio and contact/introduction workflow.

11. VC Matching

Match startups against investors using sector, stage, geography, ticket size, fundraising status, business model, traction and investment thesis. Show a match score and explain why an investor is relevant.

12. Ecosystem Features

- **Startup Perks:** software, cloud, legal, accounting, recruitment, banking, marketing and professional-service benefits.
- **Competitions & Opportunities:** grants, accelerators, pitch competitions, hackathons, government programmes and international opportunities.
- **Podcast & Content:** founder stories, investor perspectives, roast recaps, failure stories and ecosystem education.
- **Mentor Network:** experienced founders, operators, industry experts and functional specialists.
- **Introductions:** founder-to-VC, founder-to-mentor, founder-to-corporate and founder-to-customer.

13. Founder Momentum

Over time, Founders Drive can create a Momentum signal based on execution, traction, growth, fundraising progress, hiring, product launches and completion of action plans. This should indicate which companies are moving, rather than simply ranking which companies are 'best'.

14. Content Flywheel

One monthly event can generate four founder profiles, four pitch videos, multiple short clips, four Reality Check reports, progress stories, investor commentary, podcast episodes and social content. Content attracts founders; founders attract investors; investors increase platform value; the growing ecosystem attracts sponsors and partners.

15. First-Year Targets

Metric	Year 1 Target
Startups roasted	48
Registered startups	200–300
Verified investors	50+
Mentors / ecosystem experts	100+
Startup perks	50+
Competitions / opportunities	50+
Founder members	500+

16. Recommended MVP

Phase 1 (6–8 weeks): homepage, startup directory, startup profiles, founder profiles, investor directory, investor profiles, Roast My Startup application, events, perks, competitions, podcast and registration.

Phase 2: founder dashboard, startup claiming, funding/fundraising status, action-plan tracking, progress updates, introduction requests and VC matching.

Phase 3: investor dashboard, deal flow, advanced matching, mentor marketplace, analytics and premium memberships.

17. Brand Architecture

FOUNDERS DRIVE — The Malaysian Startup Ecosystem

- Roast My Startup — Reality check
- Startup Directory — Discovery
- Capital Connect — Funding
- Founder Perks — Resources
- Opportunities — Competitions & programmes
- Founders Drive Podcast — Knowledge
- Mentor Network — Expertise
- Founder Follow-up — Accountability

18. Core Philosophy

We don't roast founders to bring them down. We challenge them to help them move faster.

The real signature of Founders Drive should be not that a startup was roasted, but that the founder was willing to open the business to scrutiny, receive honest feedback, take action, and return to show the results.

Core loop: **Pitch → Reality Check → Action Plan → Help → Follow-up → Progress.**